

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

MONDAY, APRIL 6, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 79

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

Last week: DJIA 46504.67 ▲ 1338.03 2.96% NASDAQ 21879.18 ▲ 4.4% STOXX 600 596.63 ▲ 3.7% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 24/32, yield 4.344% OIL \$111.54 ▲ \$11.90 EURO \$1.1521 YEN 159.66

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The war in the Middle East** is diminishing the attraction of value stocks to cautious investors, threatening to upend the trade and leave those looking for a hedge with one less option. **B1**
- ◆ **For all its drawbacks** elsewhere, the war-induced oil shock has rewarded shareholders of U.S. oil-and-gas companies, transforming a flagging industry into one of the market's few havens. **B1**
- ◆ **Exploiting the** inaccessibility of competitors' raw materials in the Middle East, U.S. chemical makers have been able to raise prices of plastics and plastics precursors. **B1**
- ◆ **Universal Pictures'** and Nintendo's "The Super Mario Galaxy Movie" posted the biggest opening of 2026 so far with an estimated \$372.5 million in worldwide box-office sales. **B4**
- ◆ **PepsiCo and Diageo** pulled their sponsorships of a major London music festival set for this summer after Kanye West was booked as the headline performer. **B3**
- ◆ **Executives formerly** with Grubhub are looking to challenge AAA with apps that put drivers in need in touch with tow trucks and other roadside help. **B3**
- ◆ **Thousands of striking** beef-plant workers in Colorado agreed to return to work, ending a three-week strike at a slaughter plant owned by JBS, the world's largest meatpacker. **B2**
- ◆ **OpenAI and Anthropic** face a potential problem in the escalating cost of training each new iteration of an AI model as the companies race toward their initial public offerings. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump threatened** to destroy all of Iran's power plants if the country's leaders don't agree to reopen the Strait of Hormuz by Tuesday evening, piling more pressure on Tehran. **A1**
- ◆ **Trans-Atlantic ties** between the U.S. and Europe are deteriorating, with tensions over the Iran war adding to a sense that the world's most important geopolitical partnership is sliding toward dissolution. **A8**
- ◆ **More aspiring lawyers** are asking for and getting extra time to finish the bar exam, a development that follows one coursing through high schools and colleges. **A1**
- ◆ **The new tax deduction** for overtime pay is on track to be claimed by about twice as many people as projected when it was created last year, new data show. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump is reshaping** how the federal government collects money and where those funds are spent while doing little, on net, to rein in federal deficits. **A5**
- ◆ **A contractor is** deploying fleets of drones to high schools as part of state-funded programs to increase security and reduce gun violence. **A3**
- ◆ **China reserved** offshore airspace without explanation for a period of 40 days, issuing alerts similar to those that precede Beijing's military exercises, which typically last no more than a few days. **A9**
- ◆ **The U.S. repatriated** to China a Chinese fugitive suspected of drug smuggling, the first case of its kind in recent years. **A9**

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Christians Celebrate Easter's Message of Hope



REJOICE: Archbishop Ronald Hicks, third from left, led Easter Mass on Sunday at St. Patrick's Cathedral in New York City. At the Vatican, Pope Leo XIV emphasized Easter's message of hope as a celebration of Jesus' resurrection after being crucified.

Force, Deception Were Crucial To U.S. Airman's Rescue in Iran

High-risk mission occurred as hostile forces closed in on the injured aviator

For nearly two days, injured and alone, a U.S. aviator hid in a remote mountain crevice as Iranian forces and militias closed in on him with helicopters and drones. "God is good," the Air Force colonel had radioed once he reached an elevated ridge, a message that was initially met with suspicion in Washington as a possible Iranian trap as

officials tried to verify he was still alive.

Early Sunday, he heard the heavier roar of U.S. aircraft and a barrage of fire as U.S. commandos reached him 200 miles deep inside Iran. As they whisked him to safety, they blew up aircraft stranded on the ground rather than risk the sophisticated military equipment falling into Iranian hands, leaving behind a final explosion and a plume of smoke.

The rescue mission U.S. officials said unfolded in the craggy gorges of southwestern Iran was the kind of operation military commanders both plan

By Vera Bergengruen, Alexander Ward, Michael R. Gordon and Shelby Holliday

for and dread: a downed U.S. airman in enemy territory, hostile forces converging, and early attempts faltering under fire.

The aviator, who hasn't been identified, had been one of the two crew flying in an F-15E Strike Eagle with the aircraft call sign "Dude 44" when it was shot down by Iranian forces on Friday.

Shortly after the plane crashed, Defense Secretary

Pete Hegseth and Gen. Dan Caine, chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, briefed President Trump about the situation, U.S. officials said. They told him the Pentagon had long planned for this scenario and could rescue the airman.

Once the Pentagon confirmed the aviator's identity, Hegseth rushed to the Oval Office to tell him and seek a final order, officials said. Trump immediately gave his approval: "We have to get him," Trump said, according to White House Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt.

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Lawyers Increasingly Are Getting Extra Time For the Bar

By Douglas Belkin

More aspiring lawyers are asking for—and getting—extra time to finish the bar exam, a Wall Street Journal analysis has found.

In California, where more people take the bar than in any other state, 14% of the nearly 8,000 test takers last July received accommodations, up from 4% a decade earlier, the state bar said.

The development follows one coursing through high schools and colleges: More students have diagnoses for disabilities like ADHD and receive extra time for coursework or the SAT. The phenomenon has reached professional licensing exams, and law firms are adapting by launching programs to support associates.

Perry Zirkel, a disability-law scholar and former dean at Pennsylvania's Lehigh University, said the need for testing accommodations for disabled students is real, but he worries about unfairness. Families that can pay for disability assessments, he said, gain advantages by gaming the system. "This gives a benefit to those who already have power and privilege, and once they get good at it, they just simply keep playing the game," Zirkel said.

The increase traces primarily to two sources: rising rates of diagnoses, and amendments in 2008 to the Americans with

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UCLA Queens Of Basketball



HISTORY A BRUIN: The squad won its first-ever title with a 79-51 rout of South Carolina on Sunday. **A18**

The Cop Who Smelled Trouble In Her Own Department

A grand jury weighs allegations of police misconduct in a road-rage homicide on Camp Swamp Road

By Valerie Bauerlein

CONWAY, S.C.—Crime-scene investigator Shellneil Tamasi stepped from her evidence van onto Camp Swamp Road roughly an hour after the shootout that killed Scott Spivey. Right away, she saw trouble.

The two suspected killers, Weldon Boyd and Bradley Williams, sat fiddling with their phones on a trailer hitched to Boyd's white Ram TRX. In any other homicide investigation, the two shooters would have been placed in separate squad cars. Their phones would have been taken away and secured as evidence.

Over the next several hours, the investiga-

tion unfolded unlike any Tamasi had seen in her six years examining crime scenes—or her 19 years in law enforcement. Many decisions that night didn't square with her experience or training, she said in a sworn deposition.

Horry County Police Department detective Alan Jones had briefed Tamasi by phone while they were both en route. It was a road-rage killing, he said. Spivey, a 33-year-old insurance adjuster, was menacing other drivers on Highway 9. He waved a gun out the window of his truck and pointed it at people he passed, including Boyd and Williams. With Boyd behind the wheel, he and Williams followed Spivey un-

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More Americans Rise To Upper Middle Class

By Rachel Louise Ensign

Randy Shilling went to public high school in Corpus Christi, Texas. He graduated from Texas A&M University with a petroleum-engineering degree.

For the first decade of his career, he lived in an apartment and worried about paying for vacations. Then, in his early 30s, he landed a job at a chemical plant that paid about 15% more plus bonuses, and life felt smoother. Around the same time, he bought a house on a golf course in the Houston suburb of Humble, Texas. Promotions and pay raises followed, and he saved more than \$3 million for retirement. Almost without realizing it, Shilling ascended into the upper middle class.

"I view myself as an average Joe. I don't have to have a fancy car. I don't have to have the greatest TV," said Shilling, who is 58. "But when I want something, I go get it."

America's middle class is becoming wealthier as more families scale the economic ladder into higher-earning groups. New research shows that the ranks of the affluent have grown markedly over the last 50 years or so, while the lower rungs of the middle class have shrunk.

In 2024, about 31% of Americans were part of the upper

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- ◆ **Overtime-tax claims** top expectations..... **A3**
- ◆ **Job market takes** hits, and keeps rolling, for now..... **A3**